CASTELLANE ADVISORY

# Luxury Outerwear Pulse

## Q3 2026 - Market, consumers, outlook

Syndicated study - published 30 September 2026

Consumer fieldwork: 20 July - 10 August 2026, n = 4,212 HNW / aspirational luxury consumers

Markets: CN, KR, JP, US, IT, FR, DE, UK

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# Key takeaways

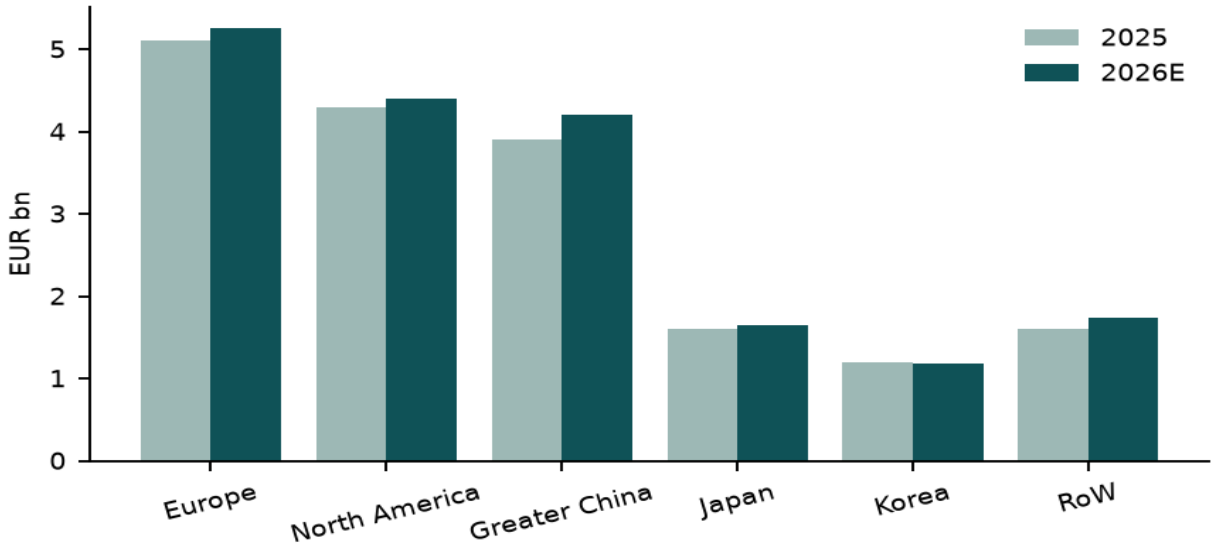
- The global luxury outerwear market is set to reach EUR 18.4 bn in 2026 (+4.1% at constant FX), a normalisation after the post-pandemic boom.
- Long down coats and ski/performance lead growth; cropped puffers are losing share (-2.3%) as the silhouette cycle turns to longer lengths.
- Korean demand is cooling: purchase intent down 8 pp quarter-on-quarter, with younger consumers trading down and travelling less to Europe.
- Chinese outbound travel to Europe still at ~72% of 2019 levels; we expect Golden Week 2026 to favour domestic and short-haul destinations (Japan, Korea, Thailand) over Europe.
- Colour: black remains dominant (46%); brown remains a niche (4%) despite runway visibility.
- Japan: weak yen and announced price increases by several houses should pull forward Q4 demand.
- Weather: seasonal models point to a mild start of autumn in Central Europe; heavy outerwear sell-through likely back-loaded to November-December.
- Designer collaborations / capsules show signs of fatigue among Chinese consumers (-5 pp in 'very interested').

*“Q4 will be a game of patience: inventory discipline over chasing early-season volume.”*

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# 1. Market size

Personal luxury outerwear (down jackets and coats, technical/ski outerwear, outerwear-adjacent knit) at retail value, constant 2025 FX. Includes DTC, wholesale and e-commerce of the 14 brands in our panel plus long tail estimate.

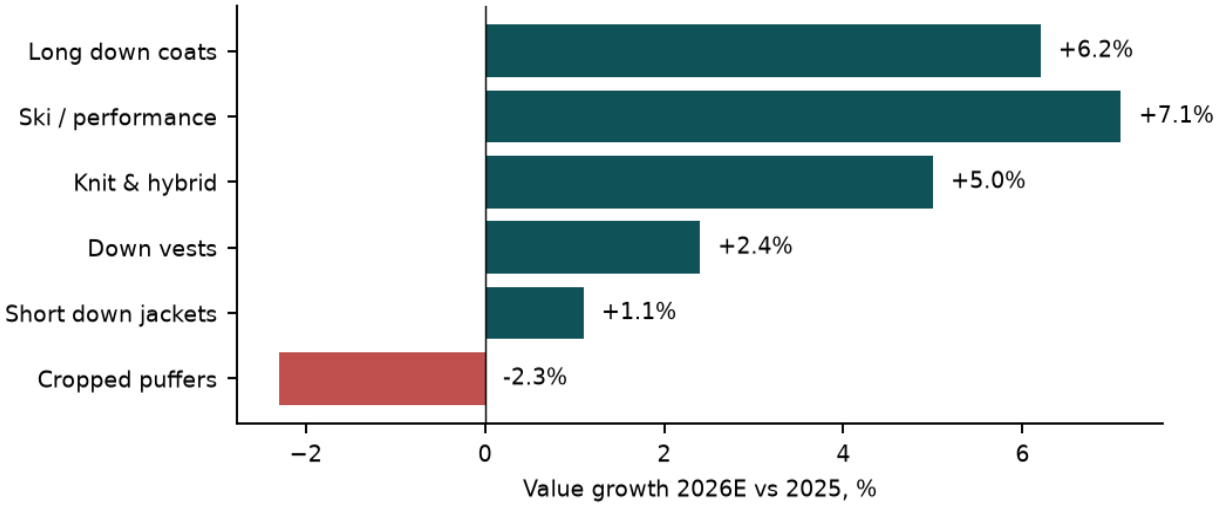



| Region | 2025 (EUR bn) | 2026E (EUR bn) | Growth |
|---|---|---|---|
| Europe | 5.10 | 5.25 | +2.9% |
| North America | 4.30 | 4.40 | +2.3% |
| Greater China | 3.90 | 4.20 | +7.7% |
| Japan | 1.60 | 1.64 | +2.5% |
| Korea | 1.20 | 1.18 | -1.7% |
| RoW | 1.60 | 1.73 | +8.1% |
| **Total** | **17.70** | **18.40** | **+4.0%** |

*Totals may not add up due to rounding. Growth 4.1% in the text refers to unrounded values.*

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# 2. Segments



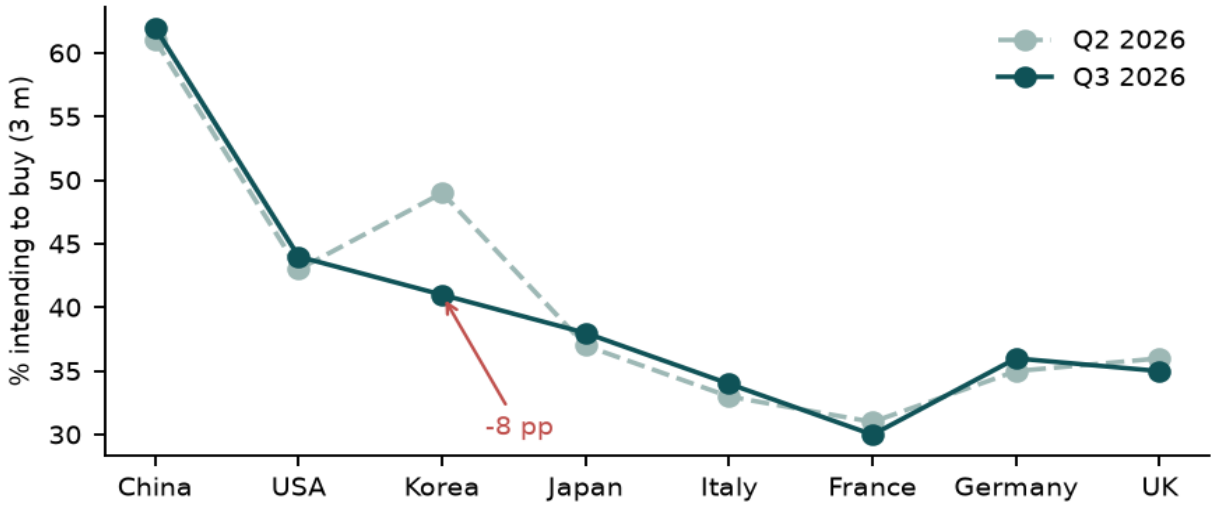

Longer silhouettes are taking over. After three seasons of growth, cropped and boxy puffers are now the weakest segment: our retail panel shows full-price sell-through on cropped styles 6 points below last year in July-August. We would be cautious on re-orders of cropped styles for FW26.

Down vests are stable; we note sporadic social-media complaints on zipper quality across several brands (not brand specific).

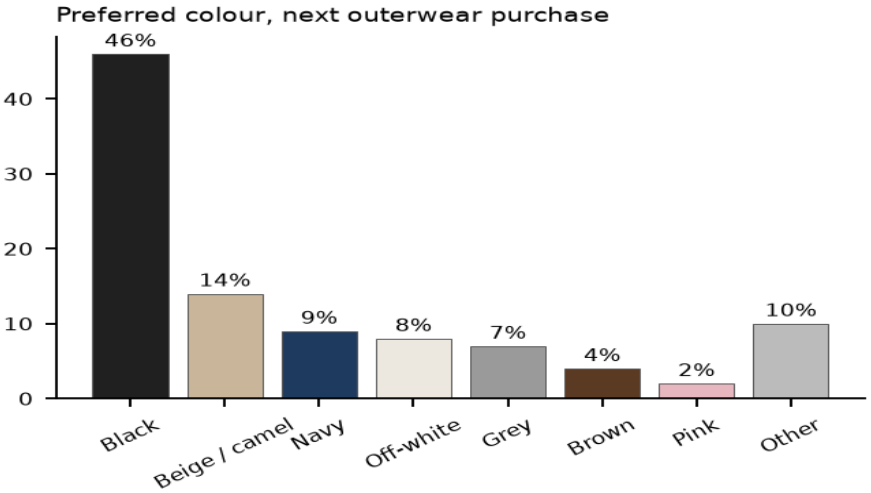
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# 3. Consumer survey

Intent to purchase luxury outerwear in the next 3 months (top-2 box), by nationality.




Korea is the only market with a significant drop (-8 pp). Drivers: higher household debt service, a strong dollar, and a shift of the 25-34 cohort towards contemporary brands. We expect Korean spending in European luxury stores to slow in H2.




Brown/chocolate is very visible on runways but remains a niche at purchase (4%); pink at 2%. We recommend keeping colour bets on core neutrals.

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# 4. Travel retail & tourism

| Flow | 2026 vs 2019 | Q4 view |
|---|---|---|
| China -> Europe | 72% | Recovery slow; GW favours domestic/short-haul |
| China -> Japan | 118% | Strong, weak yen |
| Korea -> Europe | 96% | Slowing in H2 |
| US -> Europe | 131% | Peak passed in summer |
| Middle East -> Europe | 104% | Stable |
| Japan outbound | 68% | Weak yen limits travel |

Tax-free spend data from refund operators (issued forms) confirm a soft summer for Chinese spending in Europe (-6% YoY in August). New direct routes (e.g. Chengdu-Milan) are positive but small in volume.

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# 5. Brand health (panel)

| Brand (anonymised where requested) | Awareness | Consideration | Δ consid. QoQ |
|---|---|---|---|
| Valentino | 78% | 41% | +1 pp |
| Canadian outerwear brand | 71% | 33% | +3 pp |
| French heritage ski brand | 44% | 19% | 0 pp |
| Italian luxury house A (outerwear line) | 82% | 27% | -1 pp |
| Scandinavian technical brand | 39% | 17% | +2 pp |

Capsule / designer collaborations: 'very interested' among Chinese respondents fell from 38% to 33%. We read this as early fatigue; capsule launches in Q4 may underperform in China.

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# 6. Q4 2026 outlook

- Weather: seasonal ensemble (ECMWF SEAS5 / C3S multi-system, August run) indicates above-normal temperatures in Central Europe for October; first cold spell more likely in mid-November.
- Japan: price increases announced for November by at least four houses; expect pull-forward in October.
- China: Double 11 pre-sales expected to start around 20 October, earlier than 2025; store traffic may soften.
- US: holiday season expected flat in real terms; brand campaigns should focus on incrementality measurement.
- Korea: cautious; we would not plan growth above +2%.

## Methodology

*Market sizing triangulated from company reports, retail panel (312 doors, 14 brands) and expert interviews. Consumer survey online, quota sampled; margin of error ±2-3 pp per market. Fieldwork closed on 10 August 2026: events after that date are not reflected. Not investment advice.*

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